who had been expelled from the GDR in 1983, smuggled video cameras into the GDR, enabling unique reporting for his show on SFB. As usual, the SED leadership was driven to despair by the RIAS station in the American sector.

For a short period during May, events in Honecker's family overtook work priorities. When his granddaughter Mariana died of a viral infection, amplified by air pollution, he was left devastated. Reinhardt Andert:

She had, on a regular basis, larynx inflammations, maybe every six weeks. There was a female pediatrist on the other side of the street. She could have given medication and the problem would have been settled. But for Honecker's family, they had to use the government hospital. So, they had to call and everything … it took about half an hour, but the child had already suffocated.12

Shortly after Mariana's funeral, Honecker set about keeping the church on a tighter leash. Having already warned Werner Leich, the chairman of the conference of ecclesiastical leaders, to prevent the Protestant church from becoming a place for 'anti-subversive activities,' he ordered censorship measures against religious periodicals.13 At the same time, to insulate the population from the popular changes, he tightened official state media censorship. Events, including Janos Kadar's dismissal, received only the briefest press notice, while pettifogging was employed when covering speeches and developments in the Soviet Union.

Orations by Soviet foreign-policy expert Vyacheslav Dashichev were banned after he described the Berlin Wall as a remnant 'left over from the Cold War' that had to 'disappear over time'. Ever sensitive, Central Committee secretary Hermann Axen, fired-off a terse rebuke complaining the comments were directed at the 'sovereignty and security interests of the GDR, at the security interests of the Warsaw Pact states, at our joint political defence alliance'.14 Another crisis burst open when Sputnik, a Soviet news agency magazine providing a digest of the Russian press, was